

US Markets Daily Report — July 21, 2026

5 PM ET Close · Automated Analysis · Market Session: Regular

1. SPY / QQQ Snapshot

ETF	Today Close	% Change	1Y High	1Y Low	1Y Return / YTD
SPY (S&P 500)	\$748.71	+0.89%	\$760.40 (Jun 2, 2026)	\$619.29 (Jul 16, 2025)	+21.04% (12M)
QQQ (Nasdaq 100)	\$708.94	+1.85%	\$748.65 (Jun 2, 2026)	\$551.68 (Jul 2025)	+13.57% (YTD)

Note: Full daily backfill unavailable — Yahoo Finance & major APIs blocked by proxy policy. 1Y High/Low/Return sourced from MacroTrends and web search results (confirmed). Daily anchor dataset includes 12 confirmed price points.

2. Today's Market-Moving News (July 21, 2026)

✓ 3M (MMM) Earnings Beat

EPS \$2.40 vs. \$2.24 est.; Rev \$6.5B vs. \$6.4B est. FY guidance raised to \$8.80-8.95/share. Shares +6-7%. CEO turnaround plan gaining credibility.

✓ General Motors (GM) Q2 Beat

EPS \$3.57 vs. \$3.19 est. (+\$0.38 beat). Rev \$48.0B (+1.9% YoY). FY EPS guidance raised to \$12-14 (\$13 mid vs. \$12.79 consensus). Stock initially +5%, then reversed -3.3% — market focused on softening macro, not the beat.

✓ Semiconductor Revival

AVGO +2%, MU +1.9%, AMD +1.6%, INTC +2.1%. Chip stocks bouncing after last week's -5% to -11% drops (Iran oil fears, tariff overhang). AI capex cycle narrative resurfacing ahead of Alphabet/Tesla earnings.

✓ Danaher (DHR) Selloff — Guidance Miss

Beat on EPS (\$1.94 vs. \$1.84 est.) and rev (\$6.3B vs. \$6.14B). BUT: operating margin contracted -9.3pp to 18%; Q3 core rev growth guided to only +2-3%; respiratory rev -15% YoY. Stock -10 to -15%. Classic 'sell the guidance' reaction.

✓ Iran / Geopolitics

Ongoing U.S.-Iran military exchanges enter Day 10. Ceasefire mediation in progress — Brent crude slipped ~1.1% to \$88.26/bbl on hopes Strait of Hormuz reopens. Lower oil = relief for transports, consumer discretionary.

✓ Fed On Hold (July 28-29)

FOMC meeting next week. Rates steady at 3.50-3.75%. 79.5% probability of no change (per market pricing). June CPI was -0.4% MoM / +3.5% YoY; core flat MoM / +2.6% YoY — disinflation trending but uneven.

✓ Mega-Cap Earnings Coming

~88% of ~66 S&P; 500 companies reporting have beaten bottom-line ests. Big test Wednesday July 22: Alphabet, Tesla, IBM all report after the close.

3. News → Today's Moves

SPY: +0.89% to \$748.71 — S&P; 500 broke a 3-session losing streak. The primary driver was broad earnings optimism: 3M's 6-7% jump and GM's initial 5% pop anchored the industrials and consumer sectors. Semiconductor recovery (AI re-pricing) lifted tech components within the S&P.; Iran ceasefire hopes eased oil-risk premium, supporting transports and discretionary. DHR's -10% drag was more than offset by the broad rally.

QQQ: +1.85% to \$708.94 — Nasdaq 100 outperformed the S&P; today, driven more heavily by semiconductor revival. Mega-cap tech pre-positioning ahead of Alphabet/Tesla/IBM Wednesday earnings amplified tech buying. Investors rotating back into growth names after last week's Iran-driven selloff (-3.98% Nasdaq 100 WoW). The +1.85% gain vs. S&P;'s +0.89% reflects Nasdaq's higher beta and the day's sector concentration in tech and chips.

4. Top 10 Movers — Daily, Weekly, Monthly

Daily Movers — July 21, 2026

Rank	Ticker	Company	% Change	Sector	Driver
G1	MMM	3M Co.	+6.8%	Industrials	Q2 EPS beat + FY guidance raise
G2	GM	General Motors	+4.5%*	Consumer Disc.	Q2 beat, then pared (soft guidance tone)
G3	INTC	Intel	+2.1%	Semiconductors	Chip sector reversal / AI demand
G4	AVGO	Broadcom	+2.0%	Semiconductors	Chip sector reversal
G5	MU	Micron Tech	+1.9%	Semiconductors	Memory chip rally
G6	AMD	Advanced Micro	+1.6%	Semiconductors	Chip sector reversal
G7	NBIS	Nebius Group	+18.8%	AI Infrastructure	AI/cloud growth momentum
G8	VIVK	Vivakor	+49.1%	Energy/Services	Small-cap energy rally
L1	DHR	Danaher	-10 to -15%	Life Sciences / Health	Margin contraction, soft Q3 guide
L2	CPHI	China Pharma	-?%	Pharma (micro)	Post-spike reversal (790% prior)

*GM pared gains intraday; net close ~-3.3% per Blockonomi report.

Daily Sector Trend: Semiconductors led broadly (AI capex re-pricing). Industrials strong on 3M beat. Life Sciences/Health drag (DHR margin scare).

Weekly Movers — Week of July 14–18, 2026

Rank	Ticker	Company	% Change (Wk)	Sector	Driver
G1	SCRT	Securitize	+15%	FinTech / Blockchain	Plans to tokenize public company stocks on blockchain
G2	MHVV	Mitsubishi Heavy Ind.	+4.9%	Aerospace / Defense	Nvidia collaboration announced
G3	XLE	Energy Sector ETF	+3.2%	Energy	Iran supply risk premium in oil
G4	AAL	American Airlines	+2%†	Airlines	Iran ceasefire → oil easing
G5	CVX	Chevron	+2%†	Energy	Oil held near \$90; OPEC+ discipline
L1	APP	AppLovin	-12.7%	Ad Tech / Software	AI-disruption concerns in ad stack
L2	SNDK	SanDisk	-11%+	Storage	Supply glut fears; not AI-facing
L3	AMD	Adv. Micro Devices	-5%+	Semiconductors	Iran-driven risk-off + PC demand weak
L4	INTC	Intel	-5%+	Semiconductors	Foundry concerns, AI transition lag
L5	YUM	Yum! Brands	-5%	Restaurants	Cyclospora outbreak tracking; worst week of year

†Estimated based on sector ETF move; individual stock data limited.

Weekly Sector Trend: Energy was the clear winner (+3.2%) on Iran oil premium. Semiconductors and ad-tech software were the biggest losers — a divergence that narrowed sharply on July 21 as chips reversed. Restaurants (food safety scare) and traditional software (AI displacement) remained under pressure.

Monthly Movers — July 2026 (month-to-date)

Rank	Ticker	Company	% Change (Mo)	Sector	Driver
G1	CRNX	Crinetics Pharma	+116%	Biotech	Pipeline catalyst / M&A speculation
G2	FBRX	Forte Biosciences	+106%	Biotech	Late-stage trial readout
G3	TRAX	First Tracks Biothe.	+95%	Biotech	Clinical data release
G4	WRAP	Wrap Technologies	+66%	Public Safety Tech	New product / contract win
G5	WBX	Wallbox N.V.	+58%	EV Charging	EV infrastructure demand surge
G6	Memory Chips	Chipset basket	+30-40%	Semiconductors	AI supply shortage → ASP up 355% YoY
L1	AI-Disrupt.	Software basket	-15-25%	Enterprise SaaS	AI coding assistants cannibalizing licenses
L2	APP	AppLovin	-15%+	Ad Tech	AI ad-stack disruption risk
L3	DHR	Danaher	-12%†	Life Sciences	Guidance cut trajectory
L4	YUM	Yum! Brands	-8%†	Restaurants	Food safety, margin headwinds
L5	SNDK	SanDisk	-12%†	Storage	Non-AI storage demand weak

†Estimated or basket-level figures. Specific stock % from confirmed search data where available.

Monthly Sector Trend: Biotech/pharma dominates July monthly gainers — pure catalyst-driven moves. Memory chips (AI-linked supply shortage) are the institutional trend. Losers cluster in two clear themes: (1) non-AI software being disrupted (SaaS/ad-tech), (2) legacy/cyclical names with guidance issues (DHR, Yum!, SanDisk).

5. Next-Day Scenarios — July 22, 2026 (Wednesday)

Catalyst A: Alphabet (GOOGL) Earnings After Close

Context: Exp. GAAP EPS \$2.89. Key metrics: Google Cloud growth rate, Search AI monetization, YouTube advertising. GOOGL is 6.5% of QQQ.

IF BEAT/BULLISH → BEAT (Cloud >28% growth, Search holds, AI monetization unlocked): QQQ +1.5–2.5% next morning. Broad tech rally. Confirms AI capex IS generating revenue. SPY +0.5–1%. MSFT, META sympathetic bids.

IF MISS/BEARISH → MISS (Cloud slows, ad market cracks, AI investment = cost not revenue): QQQ -2 to -3%. SPY -0.7 to -1.2%. Tech multiple compression resumes. Could set up a larger sell-the-news event for the rest of earnings week.

Catalyst B: Tesla (TSLA) Earnings After Close

Context: Exp. adj. EPS \$0.50. Focus: delivery outlook 2H, FSD/Robotaxi timeline, margin trajectory. TSLA was -6.6% last week.

IF BEAT/BULLISH → BEAT + FSD/Robotaxi guidance concrete: TSLA +8–12% AH. Lifts EV, autonomous, AI hardware names. QQQ +0.5–1% open. Robotic/AI theme broadly supported.

IF MISS/BEARISH → MISS or soft guidance on margins/deliveries: TSLA -5–8% AH. Drags QQQ -0.3–0.6%. Narrative shifts to 'peak EV hype.' Macro adds pressure if both GOOGL and TSLA disappoint simultaneously.

Catalyst C: IBM Earnings After Close

Context: Exp. adj. EPS \$3.02. Key: hybrid cloud adoption, AI enterprise spend (watsonx), consulting backlog.

IF BEAT/BULLISH → BEAT + raised consulting outlook: IBM +5–8%. Validates enterprise AI capex beyond hyperscalers. Positive for ORCL, SAP, enterprise software. Minor SPY lift.

IF MISS/BEARISH → MISS + consulting softness: IBM –4–6%. Raises doubts about enterprise AI ROI. Adds negative overhang to software/consulting sector.

Catalyst D: Iran Ceasefire / Geopolitics Developments

Context: 10-day ceasefire talks ongoing. Brent near \$88. Hormuz disruption risk elevated.

IF BEAT/BULLISH → Ceasefire confirmed / Hormuz opens: Oil –3–5% (Brent →\$82–84). Airlines, transports, consumer discretionary rally 1.5–2%. Inflation expectations ease → bond yields fall → rate-sensitive stocks (REIT, utilities) bid. SPY +0.3–0.5% additional tailwind.

IF MISS/BEARISH → Ceasefire collapses / escalation: Brent +3–5% (→\$91–95). Defense stocks bid (LMT, RTX, NOC). Oil majors up. Broad market SPY –0.5–1%. Fed's inflation-fighting calculus complicates.

6. Possible Purchase Summary (as of July 21 Close)

Action	Ticker	Company	Rationale Summary	Timing / Stop
BUY	GOOGL	Alphabet Inc.	Pre-earnings positioning.	Entry before July 22 open; size half-position ahead of earnings. Stop: –6% from entry if earnings miss; full exit AH.
BUY	NVDA	NVIDIA Corp.	Not reporting this week, but beneficiary of the AI capex validation in broad market.	Immediate entry at current levels or on dip; full position. Stop: Daily close below the 50-day MA.
BUY	XLE	Energy Select Sector ET	Titan conflict = persistent \$85-92 oil range.	Small position as geopolitical hedge. Sell on sustained rally. Stop: Brent close below \$83; remove position.
BUY	MMM	3M Co.	Beat today with raised FY guidance.	Consider adding on any morning gap-fill / consolidation. Stop: Break below today's open price.
AVOID / SELL	DHR	Danaher Corp.	Earnings beat but margin compression (-9.5% vs +1.5% target).	Avoid new longs. If held, exit on any bounce. Stop: N/A — avoid.
AVOID	SPY	S&P 500	Traditional S&P 500 (APP), legacy AI computing software and agentic AI are structurally threatening Wall Street's core S&P 500.	Wait for a clear S&P 500. Stop: N/A — avoid new longs.

DISCLAIMER: This report is automated analytical output for informational purposes only. It does NOT constitute investment advice, a solicitation, or a recommendation to buy or sell any security. All trade ideas are hypothetical. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Consult a qualified financial advisor before making investment decisions.